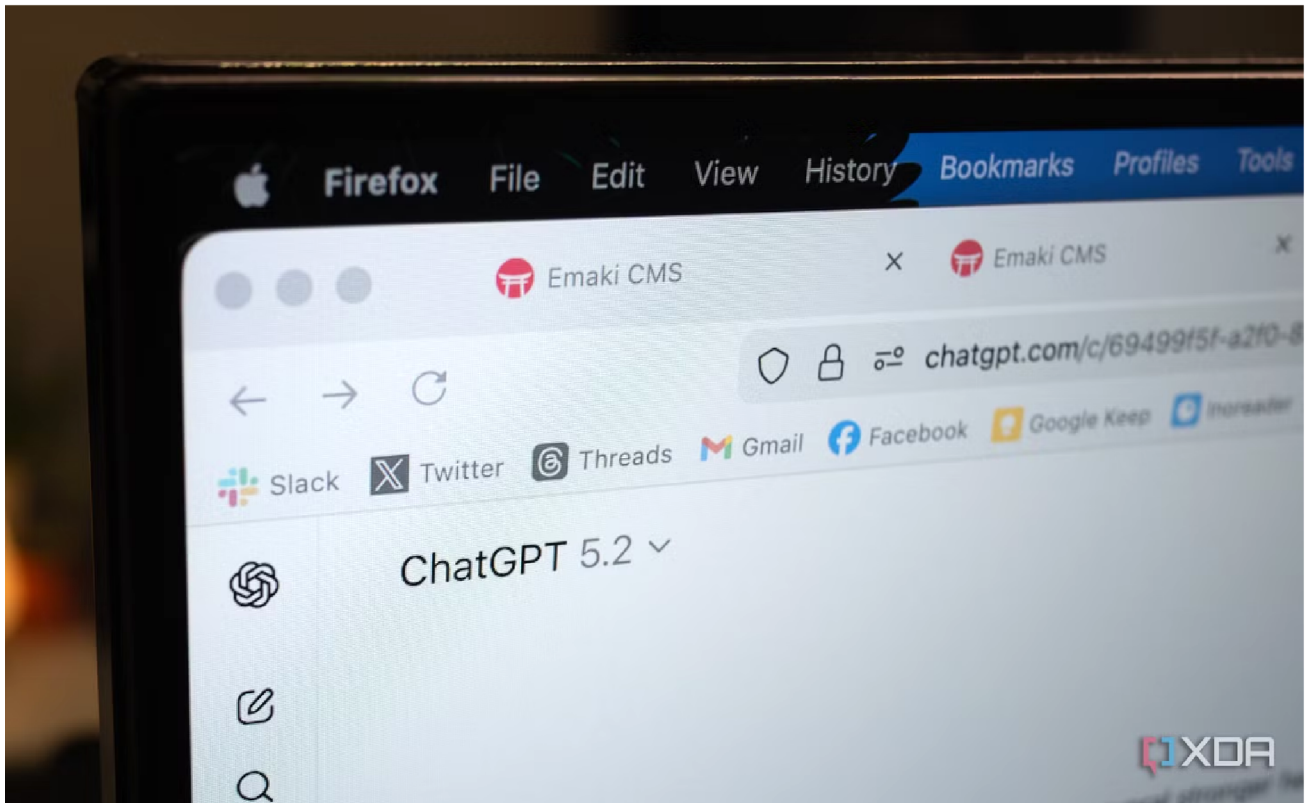




AI tools that do the same thing as ChatGPT Pro



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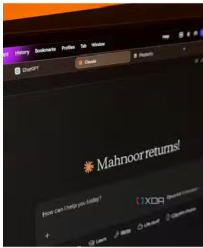


By [Dhruv Bhutani](#) — Mar 10, 2026, 6:00 AM EDT

getting around the fact that AI is an all-pervasive part of our life now. In small and meaningful ways, I have integrated AI into my productivity stack. But here's the deal: I pay for tools when they save me time or enhance how I work. For a while, ChatGPT Pro did exactly that. Between getting better answers, better reasoning, fewer limits, the upgrade made sense. But over the past year, the gap between ChatGPT Pro and free AI tools has closed fast. The problem I'm trying to solve every day is simple and universal. I need answers to the questions I ask, structured responses to research, documents, and quick iteration without constantly hitting usage limits.

[X Remove Ads](#)

of counting on ChatGPT to be the be-all and end-all AI tool to rely on, I decided to spread that word to a handful of free tools that might be better at doing the task. Each one of them has a specific need and, together, they replace ChatGPT Pro for. Here's what they.



Feb 21, 2026

I use ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini daily — here's the only one worth paying for

One stands above the rest.

By [Mahnoor Faisal](#) | 14

Remove Ads

Perplexity AI

Research done well

phase where some 5090s sold for close to 9,000 dollars. [xda-developers](#) Credit:

- In general coverage, they present the 5090 as a halo product: huge performance, huge VRAM, but very poor value compared to cheaper GPUs that already handle 4K gaming well. [xda-developers +1](#)

Market context XDA points out

- XDA also notes that rising VRAM and memory prices plus AI demand are pushing GPU prices up overall in 2026, so the 5090 is the extreme case of a broader trend rather than a one-off outlier. [xda-developers](#)
- At the same time, they highlight that older series like RTX 30 are becoming strong value on the used market, reinforcing their view that the smartest buys are well below the 5090 tier. [xda-developers](#)

From your perspective as someone who writes how-to and comparison pieces, how would

Ask a follow-up



Learn step by step



Looking for a hundred percent research accuracy, Perplexity is what I pop open first. My biggest gripe with general purpose chatbots is that they confidently present information without providing proof. Sure, they'll answer quickly. But all too often you are left wondering where

to clipboard



ing documents and structured reasoning



✕

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... is Claude, which is what I resort to when working with in-depth information. Think long
...s, or even unstructured notes. Claude ha... me very well. I can paste
...s of text and ask it to restructure, summarize, ...y argument without it
...read thanks to a larger context window.

+

...s out is how it reasons through nuance. If I ask it to compare two approaches or refine an
...: takes a systematic, scientific approach towards it and runs me through the process. That
...it when I'm structuring an opinion piece, and a solid alternative for ChatGPT's advanced
...odel.

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Gemini

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...s a spot since it fits so well into my Google-first workflow. For one, it connects beautifully
...services and handles everything from image generation to mixed inputs naturally.

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screenshot and ask what is happening, it'll respond directly. And I can do this from my phone effectively next-gen Google Lens. Similarly, if I want to brainstorm ideas and pull in current

ive a range of Gemini-powered tools, including my favorite NotebookLM. Since I'm already

Google ecosystem, I use Gemini for everything from summarizing emails to setting reminders.

se features are part of the paid tier which I subscribe to anyway for the extra storage.

most of the essential functionality is available for free.

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nice. I don't want this information tied to an account. That's when I turned to Duck.ai. As funny as it is, Duck.ai is built by DuckDuckGo, the same company that built the privacy-conscious search engine, and it focuses entirely on private AI conversations.

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web app that lets you interact with popular language models without logging in, and the app emphasizes that chats are not stored, logged, or used for any kind of training. And that's why I end up using it for sensitive searches. It's basically my scratchpad when I'm brainstorming or quick rephrases when I'm struggling with a wordy sentence. The lack of an account means pretty low friction and low risk, and that makes it useful when I don't want a trail of haphazard conversations.

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eed

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Credit:



↳, DeepSeek became popular for its low-cost development process. But the AI tool is also a
ice for its speed. When I need a quick explanation or even an ultra-quick grammar check,
an handle it without inundating you in a complicated interface. Moreover, it can even help you
nd problem-solving.



ate AI



in study and work-related uses



Ad

is an interesting tool that is purposely geared towards study and work use cases. The tool
ChatGPT style of conversational workflows but does so with a wide range of pre-configured
You'll find direct shortlinks for math solvers and physics solvers. While it still uses Gemini
and the pre-configured templates and prompts make it much easier to get started with what

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ix of AI tools works

æ AI tool replaces all the premium features of ChatGPT Pro. Moreover, you'll notice that some
ls overlap in functionality. But the good thing is that using free tools you can also get multiple
towards the same problem. Plus, I am no longer locked into one tool. Between deep research,
ling, or just speedy text edits, these tools can get you most of the ChatGPT Pro experience for

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Software and...AI

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npa

3:22:53

iation is the payment when it's free.

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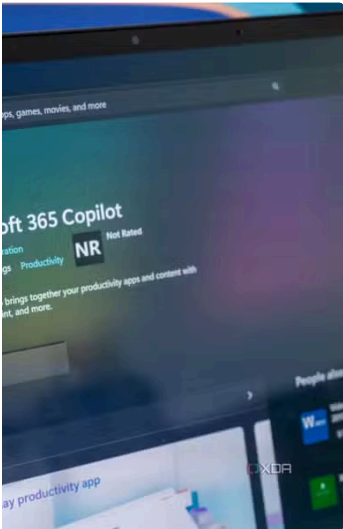
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